

sudo apters

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Theme:

Psychological horror, Light, Twist, Comic and Directional Audio environment.

The plot:

Mira wakes up in an unfamiliar, dark version of her apartment.

Her phone is ringing somewhere in the house.

She needs to find it.

As she explores, their surroundings become increasingly distorted, and a familiar voice begins telling her that they're not capable of doing even this simple task.

The player must navigate the apartment, find the phone, and then answer the call.

Central Gameplay Loop:

1. Explore the apartment
2. Follow directional audio (and comic-style HUD) clues for the phone ring.
3. Encounter a distorted environment (which is the weird, unfamiliar version of their same apartment)
4. Use the torch/light source to reveal the clues.
5. Find the next room and complete mini-activities that help the player to progress towards the phone.

The phone ringing is the reward. The player chases this reward while completing the activity. And each activity brings them closer to this reward. This way the player knows what they are doing and what are they working for, even when they don't really understand what is happening around them (that is environmental storytelling combined with psychological horror elements playing their game).

Central Gameplay Mechanics:

1. Lantern: Walking around, interacting with objects, revealing hidden clues/items/paths/objects.
2. Narrative triggers: encouraging/discouraging dialogues fighting their way into protagonist's mind.
3. Atmosphere: Dense, dark lighting, fog, sound, visual effects (comic and optical style) and timed/scripted events.

The Twist:

Who is the person calling Mira? It's herself. A few words. Enough to encourage her to combat depression for one more day.

She wakes up the next day.

The room is untidy, clothes are messed up, but she gets up. Checks her phone. It had an unread message. She opens the message. It says, "Hey, I'm here if you want to talk. Lets meet?". With a brief pause, she types "yes" and send it. She gets up, opens the curtain, the sunshine lits up her room, and she just stands there looking outside the window.

The camera slowly pans backwards, dipping to black.

The goal of the narrative is not to show that depression is fixable in one day. Its about combating it with one positive thought-its about doing very little things towards the "light" that change the thinking flow of the brain so that the person goes on being a bit better than they were the previous day.

This is the narrative structure that we have planned to make. This is just a draft plan, and changes may occur. We are also planning to use the Godot engine for this.

Thanks!